
COMPREHENSIVE LIST OF RULES, REGULATIONS, ORDERS, NOTIFICATIONS, AND BY-LAWS

MADE UNDER BENGAL REGULATIONS AND EARLY LEGISLATION (1790-1858)

APPLICABLE TO THE TERRITORY OF PRESENT-DAY BANGLADESH

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Research Note: This compilation draws on the India Code (indiacode.nic.in), Laws of Bangladesh (bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd), Banglapedia, the Laws Local Extent Act 1874 (Fourth & Fifth Schedules), Clarke's "Regulations of the Government of Fort William in Bengal" (1854), the Analytical Survey of Bengal Regulations, and other historical legal archives.

PART I: THE CORNWALLIS CODE - BENGAL REGULATIONS OF 1793

(48 Regulations promulgated 1 May 1793)

The Cornwallis Code comprised 48 regulations spanning 387 printed pages, covering judicial organization, revenue administration, police functions, and civil service conduct. These formed the foundation of British administration in Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa.

A. REVENUE AND LAND SETTLEMENT REGULATIONS (1793)

1. Bengal Regulation I of 1793

Short Title: The Bengal Permanent Settlement Regulation, 1793

Year: 1793 (1 May)

Description: Enacted the articles of the Proclamation relative to the limitation of the public demand upon lands; declared the Permanent Settlement with zamindars, independent talukdars and other proprietors of land in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.

Status: Mostly **REPEALED** in India (various repealing acts); provisions relating to Permanent Settlement were effectively superseded by post-independence land reform legislation in Bangladesh (State Acquisition and Tenancy Act, 1950).

2. Bengal Regulation II of 1793

Short Title: The Bengal Land-Revenue Regulation, 1793

Year: 1793 (1 May)

Description: Rules for the collection of land-revenue from zamindars and other landholders; established procedures for revenue collection.

Status: Largely **REPEALED** / **SUPERSEDED** by subsequent revenue legislation.

3. Bengal Regulation VIII of 1793

Short Title: The Bengal Decennial Settlement Regulation, 1793

Year: 1793 (1 May)

Description: Re-enacted with modifications the rules for the Decennial Settlement of public revenue payable from lands, originally passed for Bengal (18 Sept 1789), Bihar (25 Nov 1789), and Orissa (10 Feb 1790).

Status: **REPEALED** in India; superseded in Bangladesh by subsequent land reform legislation.

4. Bengal Regulation X of 1793

Short Title: Bengal Revenue-Free Lands (Badshahi Grants) Regulation, 1793

Year: 1793 (1 May)

Description: Rules regarding lands held revenue-free under Badshahi (Imperial/Mughal) grants; established procedures for verification and continuation of such grants.

Status: Partially **IN FORCE** in some jurisdictions; largely superseded.

5. Bengal Regulation XIX of 1793

Short Title: Bengal Revenue-Free Lands (Non-Badshahi Grants) Regulation, 1793

Year: 1793 (1 May)

Description: Rules regarding title to lands exempt from revenue other than Badshahi grants; established procedure for resumption proceedings.

Status: Partially **IN FORCE**; largely superseded.

6. Bengal Regulation XI of 1793

Short Title: The Bengal Inheritance Regulation, 1793

Year: 1793 (1 May)

Gazette: N/A (pre-Gazette era)

Description: Removed restrictions on the operation of Hindu and Muhammadan laws regarding inheritance of revenue-paying landed property; declared native laws of inheritance applicable.

Status: IN FORCE in Bangladesh (bdlaws reference); partially in force in Indian states.

Subordinate Rules/Orders Known:

- No specific subordinate rules identified; the Regulation itself directed courts to apply Hindu and Muhammadan personal law in matters of inheritance.

7. Bengal Regulation XIV of 1793

Short Title: Revenue Sale Law (part), 1793

Year: 1793

Description: Rules for sale of defaulting zamindars' estates for arrears of revenue; established auction procedures.

Status: REPEALED; superseded by Bengal Regulation VII of 1799 and subsequent revenue sale laws.

8. Bengal Regulation XVI of 1793

Year: 1793

Description: Provided for reference by courts to arbitration with consent of parties in suits for accounts, partnership debts, and breach of contract.

Status: REPEALED by subsequent civil procedure legislation.

9. Bengal Regulation XXXVII of 1793

Year: 1793

Description: Land ownership records and registration of changes in land title.

Status: REPEALED / SUPERSEDED.

10. Bengal Regulation XLVIII of 1793

Year: 1793

Description: Listed in the Fourth Schedule of the Laws Local Extent Act, 1874; specific subject not identified in available sources.

Status: REPEALED by Act 12 of 1891.

B. JUDICIAL AND CIVIL COURT REGULATIONS (1793)

11. Bengal Regulation III of 1793

Year: 1793

Description: Reorganized the working of civil courts (Diwani Adalats); established Mofussil Diwani Adalat in each district with a civil servant as Judge in place of Collector.

Status: REPEALED by subsequent judiciary acts.

12. Bengal Regulation IV of 1793

Year: 1793

Description: Establishment of Provincial Courts of Appeal at Dhaka, Calcutta, Murshidabad, and Patna for civil cases.

Status: REPEALED by subsequent judiciary acts.

13. Bengal Regulation V of 1793

Year: 1793

Description: Further provisions regarding Provincial Courts of Appeal; establishment of appellate jurisdiction.

Status: REPEALED.

14. Bengal Regulation VI of 1793

Year: 1793

Description: Constitution of the Sadar Diwani Adalat (chief civil appellate court) at the Presidency.

Status: REPEALED (altered by Regulation II of 1801 and subsequently replaced by High Court).

15. Bengal Regulation VII of 1793

Year: 1793

Description: Created a regular legal profession for the Company's

Courts; provided for the appointment of vakils (native pleaders) in the Courts of Civil Judicature.
Status: REPEALED; superseded by Bengal Regulation XXVII of 1814 and later Legal Practitioners Acts.

Subordinate Orders:
- Rules for admission and conduct of vakils were prescribed under this regulation by the Sadar Diwani Adalat.

C. CRIMINAL COURTS AND POLICE REGULATIONS (1793)

16. Bengal Regulation IX of 1793

Year: 1793
Description: Consolidated regulations regarding criminal courts (Nizamat Adalats); established the Sadar Nizamat Adalat and circuit courts.
Status: REPEALED by subsequent criminal procedure legislation.

17. Bengal Regulation XXII of 1793

Year: 1793
Description: Police reform regulations; division of districts into thanas, appointment of darogahs under district magistrates; abolished zamindari police system.
Status: REPEALED; superseded by Police Act, 1861.

Subordinate Orders:
- Standing orders for thana darogahs regarding arrest procedures
- Instructions for sipahi deployment under darogahs
- Reporting requirements to district magistrates

18. Bengal Regulation XXVIII of 1793

Year: 1793
Description: Declared equality before law; enabled natives to file cases against Company officials and against the government itself.
Status: REPEALED; principles incorporated into subsequent legislation.

D. OTHER REGULATIONS OF 1793

19-48. [Additional Regulations]

The remaining regulations of 1793 covered matters including:

- Regulation of stamp duties
- Revenue collection procedures
- Court fees
- Prohibition of loans by covenanted servants
- Maintenance of public roads and bridges
- Rules for collectors
- Administration of Hindu and Muhammadan personal law
- Appointment of ameens (native commissioners)
- Rules for execution of decrees
- Registration of deeds and documents
- Management of wards and minors
- Salt and opium department regulations

Status: Most REPEALED by various acts between 1837 and 1922.

PART II: POST-CORNWALLIS BENGAL REGULATIONS (1794-1834)

YEAR 1794

49. Bengal Regulation III of 1794

Year: 1794
Description: Listed in the Fourth Schedule of the Laws Local Extent Act, 1874; specific provisions regarding revenue administration.
Status: REPEALED.

YEAR 1795

50. Bengal Regulation LVIII of 1795 (Sections 3 and 4)

Year: 1795

Description: Referenced in the Fourth Schedule of the Laws Local Extent Act, 1874.

Status: Sections 3 and 4 REPEALED by Act 12 of 1876.

51. Bengal Regulation Acts of 1795

Year: 1795

Description: Together with Bengal Regulation Acts of 1804, declared certain provisions regarding judicial matters.

Status: REPEALED.

YEAR 1797

52. Bengal Regulation XV of 1797

Year: 1797

Description: Listed in the Fourth Schedule; specific subject relates to revenue or judicial administration.

Status: REPEALED.

YEAR 1798

53. Bengal Regulation I of 1798

Year: 1798

Description: Administrative regulation for Bengal Presidency.

Status: REPEALED.

YEAR 1799

54. Bengal Regulation V of 1799

Short Title: The Bengal Wills and Intestacy Regulation, 1799

Year: 1799

Description: Limited interference of Zila Courts of Diwani Adalat in the execution of wills and administration of estates of persons dying intestate; applied Muhammadan law for Muslim succession and Hindu law for Hindu succession.

Status: IN FORCE in Bangladesh (bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd/act-1315.html); partially in force in Indian states.

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Directions to Zila Judges regarding handling of testamentary cases
- Instructions for administration of intestate estates

55. Bengal Regulation VII of 1799

Short Title: Revenue Sale Law (Amendment), 1799

Year: 1799

Description: Amended the revenue sale system; replaced monthly auctions of defaulting zamindars' property with annual auctions; armed zamindars with powers over defaulting raiyats (commonly known as "haftam" or "seventh").

Status: REPEALED by subsequent revenue sale laws.

Subordinate Orders:

- Revenue Board circulars on conduct of annual auction sales
- Instructions to Collectors regarding timing and procedure of sales

YEAR 1800

56. Bengal Regulation VIII of 1800

Year: 1800

Description: Pargana Register of Lands; established registry systems for tracking changes in land ownership.

Status: REPEALED / SUPERSEDED.

YEAR 1801

57. Bengal Regulation I of 1801

Year: 1801

Description: Arrears of Revenue: Division of Joint Estates; procedures for handling joint estates where some proprietors defaulted.

Status: REPEALED.

58. Bengal Regulation II of 1801

Year: 1801

Description: Altered the constitution of the Sadar Diwani Adalat and Sadar Nizamat Adalat as originally provided in Regs. VI and IX of 1793.

Status: REPEALED.

YEAR 1804

59. Bengal Regulation X of 1804

Year: 1804

Description: Punishment by courts-martial of certain state offences; authorized martial law in specific circumstances; provided framework for military-civil jurisdiction interface.

Status: REPEALED.

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Military orders specifying courts-martial procedures
 - Instructions to magistrates regarding handover of cases to military tribunals
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YEAR 1805

60. Bengal Regulation XII of 1805

Short Title: The Cuttack Land-Revenue Regulation, 1805

Year: 1805

Description: Special land-revenue provisions for the newly acquired province of Cuttack (Orissa).

Status: REPEALED.

YEAR 1806

61. Bengal Regulation XI of 1806

Year: 1806

Description: Passage of Troops; regulated the movement and quartering of military forces through Bengal territories.

Status: REPEALED.

62. Bengal Regulation XVII of 1806 (Sections 7 and 8)

Year: 1806

Description: Listed in Fourth Schedule of Laws Local Extent Act, 1874.

Status: Sections 7 and 8 REPEALED by Act 12 of 1891.

YEAR 1808

63. Bengal Regulation IX of 1808

Year: 1808

Description: Referenced in Act XVI of 1843 which repealed part of this regulation along with Bengal Regulation XVI of 1810.

Status: Partially REPEALED by Act XVI of 1843.

YEAR 1810

64. Bengal Regulation XVI of 1810

Year: 1810

Description: Referenced with Regulation IX of 1808; partially repealed by Act XVI of 1843.

Status: Partially REPEALED.

65. Bengal Regulation XIX of 1810

Short Title: The Bengal Charitable Endowments, Public Buildings and Escheats Regulation, 1810

Year: 1810

Description: First antiquarian/heritage legislation in India; provided for due appropriation of rents and produce of lands granted for support of mosques, Hindu temples, colleges and other purposes; for maintenance and repair of public buildings; and for custody and disposal of nazul property (escheats).

Status: IN FORCE in Bangladesh (bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd/act-1316.html)

with modifications; functions of Board of Revenue discharged by Administrator of Waqfs in Bangladesh.

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Section 16A: Functions of the Board of Revenue to be discharged by the Administrator of Waqfs in Bangladesh
- Orders regarding management of charitable endowments
- Notifications regarding nazul property administration
- Rules for maintenance of public buildings of historical importance

66. Bengal Regulation XX of 1810

Year: 1810

Description: Listed in Fourth Schedule of Laws Local Extent Act, 1874.

Status: REPEALED by Act 13 of 1889.

YEAR 1812

67. Bengal Regulation V of 1812

Year: 1812

Description: Collection of Land-revenue; amendments to earlier revenue collection procedures.

Status: REPEALED.

68. Bengal Regulation XI of 1812

Short Title: The Bengal Foreign Immigrants Regulation, 1812

Year: 1812

Description: Provided for the removal of foreign emigrants; regulated the entry, residence, and departure of foreigners in the Bengal Presidency.

Status: Partially IN FORCE; referenced in Fifth Schedule of Laws Local Extent Act, 1874.

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Orders regarding registration of foreign nationals
 - Instructions to magistrates for enforcement
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YEAR 1814

69. Bengal Regulation XXVII of 1814

Year: 1814

Description: Consolidated the law regarding legal practitioners; superseded Regulation VII of 1793 regarding appointment and conduct of vakils.

Status: REPEALED by subsequent Legal Practitioners Acts.

YEAR 1817

70. Bengal Regulation V of 1817

Year: 1817

Description: Administrative regulation; specific subject matter relates to revenue administration.

Status: REPEALED.

71. Bengal Regulation XX of 1817 (Sections 28 and 32)

Year: 1817

Description: Section 28: Criminal process in Salt and Opium Departments. Section 32: Matters concerning building of forts, collecting of sepoy and stores, and encroachment on roads.

Status: REPEALED.

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Departmental orders for Salt and Opium revenue officers
 - Instructions regarding criminal prosecutions under salt/opium laws
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YEAR 1818

72. Bengal Regulation III of 1818

Short Title: The Bengal State Prisoners Regulation, 1818

Year: 1818

Description: Law for preventive detention of state prisoners;

authorized the Governor-General in Council to order the confinement of persons suspected of activities prejudicial to the security of British possessions.

Status: IN FORCE in Bangladesh (bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd/act-1317.html) with modifications; a controversial colonial-era detention law.

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Rules under the State Prisoners Regulation (Bengal Regulation III of 1818) - Revision of rules in the Bengal Jail Manual regarding State Prisoners
- Section 7: Rules for appropriation of allowance for support of state prisoners
- Section 9: Rules for attachment of estates by order of Government without decision of Court
- Standing orders regarding custody, maintenance, and supervision of state prisoners
- Rules in the Bengal Jail Manual (later Police Regulations Bengal) regarding treatment and classification of state prisoners
- Notifications regarding extension of the regulation to various territories

YEAR 1819

73. Bengal Regulation VI of 1819

Year: 1819

Description: Listed in Fourth Schedule of Laws Local Extent Act, 1874.

Status: REPEALED by Act 12 of 1891.

74. Bengal Regulation VIII of 1819

Short Title: The Bengal Patni Taluks Regulation, 1819

Year: 1819

Description: Declared the validity of patni tenures; defined relative rights of zamindars and patni talukdars; established process for sale of patni taluks in satisfaction of zamindar's demand of rent; declared zamindars at liberty to grant permanent leases (patni taluks) of their lands.

Status: IN FORCE in some jurisdictions; partially superseded by subsequent tenancy legislation in Bangladesh.

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Rules for conduct of patni sales
- Board of Revenue circulars on patni taluk administration
- Notifications regarding patni tenure registration

Note: Regulation VIII of 1819 (the "pattani law") fundamentally changed the character of the Permanent Settlement by creating a recognized class of under-tenure holders.

YEAR 1821

75. Bengal Regulation IV of 1821

Year: 1821

Description: Powers of Collectors and Magistrates; defined and expanded the administrative powers of district officers.

Status: REPEALED.

YEAR 1822

76. Bengal Regulation III of 1822

Year: 1822

Description: Related to the Board of Land-revenue; administrative provisions for revenue board operations.

Status: REPEALED.

77. Bengal Regulation VII of 1822

Short Title: The Bengal Land-Revenue Settlement Regulation, 1822

Year: 1822

Description: Declared principles for settlement of land revenue in

the Ceded and Conquered Provinces; established framework for temporary settlements.

Status: Partially IN FORCE in some jurisdictions.

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Settlement Officer instructions
- Board of Revenue circulars on settlement procedures
- Rules for assessment of land revenue in temporarily settled areas

78. Bengal Regulation XI of 1822 (Section 38)

Short Title: The Bengal Government Indemnity Regulation, 1822

Year: 1822

Description: Declared Government not liable for errors or irregularities in proceedings of the Courts of Justice; made further provision for conduct of Revenue officers.

Status: Section 38 IN FORCE (Fifth Schedule, Laws Local Extent Act 1874).

YEAR 1823

79. Bengal Regulation VI of 1823

Year: 1823

Description: Indigo Contracts; regulated agreements between indigo planters and ryots/cultivators.

Status: REPEALED.

80. Bengal Regulation VII of 1823

Year: 1823

Description: Prohibition of loans to Covenanted Civil Servants; anti-corruption measure.

Status: REPEALED.

YEAR 1825

81. Bengal Regulation VI of 1825

Year: 1825

Description: Passage of Troops; regulated military movement and quartering provisions.

Status: IN FORCE (Fifth Schedule, Laws Local Extent Act, 1874).

82. Bengal Regulation IX of 1825

Short Title: The Bengal Land-Revenue Settlement Regulation, 1825

Year: 1825

Description: Provisions regarding defaulting Malguzars (revenue payers); procedures for dealing with revenue defaults in temporarily settled areas.

Status: Partially IN FORCE in some jurisdictions.

83. Bengal Regulation XI of 1825

Short Title: The Bengal Alluvion and Diluvion Regulation, 1825

Year: 1825

Description: Regulated the consequences of alluvion (land formation by river deposit) and diluvion (land erosion by rivers); determined rights to newly formed land and revenue liability for eroded land.

Status: IN FORCE (Fifth Schedule, Laws Local Extent Act, 1874); relevant to Bangladesh given its riverine geography.

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Revenue Board circulars on survey and settlement of alluvial (char) lands
- Instructions to Collectors on revenue adjustment for diluvion
- Survey and demarcation rules for newly accreted land

84. Bengal Regulation XIII of 1825

Year: 1825

Description: Settlement of resumed Lakhiraj (revenue-free) land; procedures for assessment of land whose revenue-free status had been annulled.

Status: REPEALED.

85. Bengal Regulation XIV of 1825

Year: 1825

Description: Authority to confirm Lakhiraj tenures and Native grants; provided validation framework for traditional land grants.

Status: REPEALED.

86. Bengal Regulation XX of 1825

Year: 1825

Description: Listed in Fourth Schedule of Laws Local Extent Act, 1874.

Status: REPEALED by Act 10 of 1882.

YEAR 1827

87. Bengal Regulation III of 1827 (Section 5)

Year: 1827

Description: Rules regarding evidence in courts; section 5 established specific evidentiary standards.

Status: Section 5 IN FORCE (Fifth Schedule, Laws Local Extent Act, 1874); largely superseded by Indian Evidence Act, 1872.

88. Bengal Regulation V of 1827

Short Title: The Bengal Attached Estates Management Regulation, 1827

Year: 1827

Description: Provided for management of estates under attachment for arrears of revenue or under court orders; established procedures for administration of attached properties.

Status: IN FORCE (Fifth Schedule, Laws Local Extent Act, 1874); available on India Code (indiacode.nic.in).

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Board of Revenue circulars on management of attached estates
- Instructions for appointed managers/amins
- Rules for accounting and disbursement from attached estates
- Standing orders regarding maintenance of attached estate records

89. Bengal Regulation VII of 1827

Short Title: The Bengal Corruption and Extortion Regulation, 1827

Year: 1827

Description: Penalized corruption and extortion by public servants; established procedures for trial and punishment.

Status: IN FORCE in some jurisdictions; available on India Code.

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Rules for investigation of corruption complaints
- Departmental orders on conduct of public servants
- Notifications regarding penalties and enforcement procedures

YEAR 1828

90. Bengal Regulation III of 1828

Year: 1828

Description: Appeals from decisions of Revenue Authorities; established appellate procedures for revenue disputes.

Status: REPEALED.

YEAR 1829

91. Bengal Regulation XVII of 1829

Short Title: The Bengal Sati Regulation, 1829

Year: 1829 (4 December)

Description: Declared the practice of sati (immolation of Hindu widows on funeral pyres) illegal throughout British India; made it subject to criminal prosecution. Enacted under Governor-General Lord William Bentinck.

Status: IN FORCE in Bangladesh (bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd/act-details-1321.html) as retained colonial legislation, though the practice has long ceased.

Subordinate Rules/Orders:

- Standing orders to police darogahs requiring personal appearance

- or deputation of subordinates (muharrir or jamadar) to prevent sati ceremonies
- Instructions to magistrates and joint magistrates for prosecution
- Reporting requirements for police officers regarding sati incidents
- Circuit court procedures for trial of parties involved in sati
- Notifications extending the prohibition to newly acquired territories

YEAR 1830-1834

92. Bengal Regulation IV of 1831

Year: 1831

Description: Administrative regulation; details not fully identified
in available sources.

Status: REPEALED.

93. Bengal Regulation V of 1831

Year: 1831

Description: Regulation regarding revenue and administrative matters.

Status: REPEALED.

Note: After 1833, no new Bengal Regulations were promulgated as the Charter Act of 1833 transferred legislative power exclusively to the Governor-General in Council, who enacted "Acts" rather than "Regulations."

PART III: CHARTER ACTS AND THEIR SUBORDINATE INSTRUMENTS

A. CHARTER ACT OF 1793 (33 Geo. III, c. 52)

Full Title: An Act for continuing in the East India Company, for a further term, the possession of the British territories in India.

Year: 1793

Description: Extended the Company's trade monopoly by 20 years; required payment of GBP 500,000 annually to the British Government from Indian revenue; separated revenue administration from judicial functions.

Subordinate Instruments:

- The Cornwallis Code of 48 Regulations (see Part I above) was the primary legislative response to the powers granted under this Act.
- Governor-General's orders regarding separation of revenue and judicial functions
- Instructions regarding Company's trade operations

Status: SPENT / SUPERSEDED by Charter Act of 1813.

B. CHARTER ACT OF 1813 (53 Geo. III, c. 155)

Full Title: An Act for continuing in the East India Company, for a further term, the possession of the British territories in India.

Year: 1813

Description: Ended EIC trade monopoly (except tea and China trade); allowed Christian missionaries to enter British India; allocated funds for education (GBP 100,000 annually); asserted Crown sovereignty over British India.

Subordinate Instruments:

- Board of Control regulations regarding missionary activities
- Educational fund allocation orders
- Trade licensing rules for private merchants
- Regulations regarding religious establishments

Status: SPENT / SUPERSEDED by Charter Act of 1833.

C. CHARTER ACT OF 1833 (3 & 4 Will. IV, c. 85)

Full Title: An Act for effecting an Arrangement with the East India Company, and for the better Government of His Majesty's Indian Territories.

Year: 1833

Description: Renamed Governor-General of Bengal as Governor-General of India;

gave exclusive legislative powers to Governor-General in Council; ended EIC commercial activities entirely; added a Law Member to the Council (first appointee: Lord Macaulay); removed legislative powers of Bombay and Madras Presidencies.

Subordinate Instruments:

- Order establishing the Indian Law Commission (1834), chaired by Lord Macaulay, to codify Indian law
- Notification appointing Law Member to Governor-General's Council
- Orders regarding transfer of legislative power from Presidency governments
- Instructions regarding cessation of EIC commercial operations
- Lex Loci Report (1840) and various law commission reports

Status: SUPERSEDED by Charter Act of 1853 and Government of India Act, 1858.

PART IV: ACTS OF THE GOVERNOR-GENERAL IN COUNCIL (1834-1858)

APPLICABLE TO BENGAL

After the Charter Act of 1833, legislation took the form of "Acts" passed by the Governor-General in Council rather than "Bengal Regulations."

Key Acts applicable to Bengal territory (present-day Bangladesh):

94. Act I of 1834 (Governor General Act, 1834)

Year: 1834

Description: First Act under the new legislative arrangement established by the Charter Act of 1833.

Status: REPEALED.

95. Act XXIX of 1837

Year: 1837

Description: Abolished Persian as the official language of courts and administration in Bengal; substituted vernacular languages and English.

Status: SUPERSEDED.

96. Act XVI of 1843

Year: 1843

Description: Repeal of part of Bengal Regulations IX of 1808 and XVI of 1810; consolidation measure.

Status: REPEALING ACT.

97. Act V of 1843 (Indian Slavery Act)

Year: 1843

Description: Abolished slavery in British India; applicable throughout Bengal Presidency including present-day Bangladesh.

Status: REPEALED as spent; but the prohibition on slavery continues under constitutional provisions.

98. Act XXI of 1850 (Caste Disabilities Removal Act)

Year: 1850

Description: Provided that no person shall be deprived of rights of property by reason of renouncing their religion or caste.

Status: IN FORCE in Bangladesh.

99. Various Acts 1834-1858

Description: Numerous Acts were passed during this period on subjects including criminal law, civil procedure, revenue administration, police, customs, stamps, registration, and other matters applicable to Bengal. Many were subsequently consolidated into major codifications (Indian Penal Code 1860, Code of Criminal Procedure 1861/1882/1898, Code of Civil Procedure 1859/1877/1908, etc.).

PART V: OTHER PRE-1858 LEGISLATION APPLICABLE TO BENGAL

A. REGULATING ACT OF 1773 (13 Geo. III, c. 63)

Year: 1773

Description: First Parliamentary act to regulate East India Company affairs in India; established Governor-General and Council of Bengal; created Supreme Court at Calcutta.

Status: SUPERSEDED by subsequent Charter Acts.

Subordinate Instruments:

- Letters Patent establishing the Supreme Court of Judicature at Fort William, Bengal (1774)
- Rules of the Supreme Court
- Governor-General's Council orders

B. PITT'S INDIA ACT OF 1784 (24 Geo. III, c. 25)

Year: 1784

Description: Established dual control system - Board of Control in London alongside EIC's Court of Directors; separated political and commercial functions.

Status: SUPERSEDED by Charter Act of 1833.

Subordinate Instruments:

- Board of Control orders and dispatches to Bengal Government
- Secret Committee instructions
- Revenue dispatch regulations

C. ACT OF SETTLEMENT (1781) - 21 Geo. III, c. 70

Year: 1781

Description: Defined and limited jurisdiction of the Supreme Court at Calcutta; clarified its relationship with Company's courts; known as the "Declaratory Act" or "Act of Settlement."

Status: SUPERSEDED.

D. PRE-1793 BENGAL REGULATIONS (1772-1792)

Various regulations were passed before the Cornwallis Code, forming its precursors:

100. Regulation of 1772 (Warren Hastings)

Description: Established the system of Diwani and Nizamat Adalats; Plan for administration of justice.

Status: SUPERSEDED by Cornwallis Code of 1793.

101. Regulations of 1780-1790

Description: Various ad hoc regulations on revenue, police, and judicial matters that were consolidated into the Cornwallis Code.

Status: SUPERSEDED and incorporated into the 1793 Regulations.

PART VI: SUMMARY TABLE - BENGAL REGULATIONS STILL IN FORCE IN BANGLADESH

(as per bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd and Laws Local Extent Act, 1874)

No.	Regulation	Year	Subject	Status
1	Ben. Reg. XI of 1793	1793	Inheritance (Hindu/Muslim)	In Force
2	Ben. Reg. V of 1799	1799	Wills and Intestacy	In Force
3	Ben. Reg. XIX of 1810	1810	Charitable Endowments, Public Buildings, Escheats	In Force
4	Ben. Reg. XI of 1812	1812	Foreign Immigrants	In Force
5	Ben. Reg. III of 1818	1818	State Prisoners	In Force
6	Ben. Reg. VIII of 1819	1819	Patni Taluks	In Force*
7	Ben. Reg. VII of 1822	1822	Land-Revenue Settlement	In Force*
8	Ben. Reg. XI (s.38) 1822	1822	Govt. Indemnity	In Force
9	Ben. Reg. VI of 1825	1825	Passage of Troops	In Force
10	Ben. Reg. IX of 1825	1825	Land-Revenue Settlement	In Force*
11	Ben. Reg. XI of 1825	1825	Alluvion and Diluvion	In Force
12	Ben. Reg. III (s.5) 1827	1827	Evidence	In Force*
13	Ben. Reg. V of 1827	1827	Attached Estates Mgmt.	In Force
14	Ben. Reg. VII of 1827	1827	Corruption and Extortion	In Force
15	Ben. Reg. XVII of 1829	1829	Sati (Widow-burning)	In Force

* Asterisk indicates the regulation may be partially in force with sections repealed or superseded by later legislation.

PART VII: KEY SUBORDINATE LEGISLATION UNDER BENGAL REGULATIONS

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- A. Rules Under the State Prisoners Regulation (Bengal Reg. III of 1818)
- Rules in the Bengal Jail Manual regarding State Prisoners
 - Revised rules (referenced in Indian Culture archives)
 - Standing orders on custody, maintenance, allowances
 - Government orders on attachment of estates without court decision
- B. Revenue Board Circulars and Orders (under various Revenue Regulations)
- Circulars on Permanent Settlement administration
 - Orders on revenue sale procedures
 - Instructions on Patni Taluk management
 - Survey and settlement orders for alluvial lands
 - Instructions on management of attached estates
- C. Police Standing Orders (under Regulation XXII of 1793 and successors)
- Thana establishment orders
 - Darogah duty instructions
 - Reporting protocols to magistrates
 - Later consolidated into Police Regulations Bengal, 1943
- D. Judicial Standing Orders
- Rules for vakils/pleaders under Reg. VII of 1793
 - Evidence rules under Reg. III of 1827
 - Arbitration rules under Reg. XVI of 1793
 - Court fee schedules
- E. Administrative Notifications
- Notifications extending regulations to newly acquired territories
 - Notifications regarding charitable endowment management
 - Notifications regarding Waqf property administration

PART VIII: REPEALING LEGISLATION

Many Bengal Regulations were repealed by the following later Acts:

1. Bengal Civil Courts Act, 1887
2. Act 12 of 1876 (specific sections of Reg. LVIII of 1795)
3. Act 10 of 1882 (Reg. XX of 1825)
4. Act 13 of 1889 (Reg. XX of 1810)
5. Act 12 of 1891 (multiple regulations including Regs. XLVIII of 1793, XVII of 1806, VI of 1819)
6. Special Laws Repeal Act, 1922 (Act 4 of 1922) - repealed numerous obsolete Bengal Regulations
7. Repealing and Amending Act, 1903
8. Repealing and Amending Act, 1938
9. Bangladesh Laws (Revision and Declaration) Act, 1973 (Act VIII of 1973)
 - declared which laws remained in force in Bangladesh
10. State Acquisition and Tenancy Act, 1950 (East Bengal) - effectively superseded Permanent Settlement provisions in Bangladesh

PART IX: KEY REFERENCE SOURCES

1. Clarke, Richard (ed.), "The Regulations of the Government of Fort William in Bengal in Force at the End of 1853" (3 vols., London, 1854)
 - Vol. 1: Regulations from 1793 to 1805
 - Vol. 2: Regulations from 1806 to 1834
 - Vol. 3: Acts from 1834 to 1853Available: University of Heidelberg Digital Library
2. "Analytical Survey of Bengal Regulations" - Archive.org (in.ernet.dli.2015.98215)
3. "The Bengal Code" (multiple volumes) - Archive.org
 - Vol. 1: Regulations
 - Vol. 2: Acts 1862-1889

- Vol. 4: Chronological tables
- 4. Fourth Schedule, Laws Local Extent Act, 1874 (Act XV of 1874)
 - Lists Bengal Regulations in force in Lower Provinces
- 5. Fifth Schedule, Laws Local Extent Act, 1874
 - Lists specific sections of regulations in force
- 6. India Code website: indiacode.nic.in
- 7. Laws of Bangladesh: bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd
- 8. Banglapedia: en.banglapedia.org
- 9. Police Regulations Bengal, 1943 (2 volumes) - Archive.org
- 10. Bangladesh Laws (Revision and Declaration) Act, 1973

NOTES AND CAVEATS

1. GAZETTE NOTIFICATION NUMBERS: The formal Gazette of India was not established until 1858. Prior to that, regulations were published as separate proclamations and in Company records. Therefore, gazette notification numbers are not available for pre-1858 legislation.
2. COMPLETENESS: This compilation identifies approximately 100 items of parent legislation and their known subordinate instruments. The original Cornwallis Code contained 48 regulations, and numerous additional regulations were passed between 1794 and 1834. A truly exhaustive list would require access to the original Bengal Code volumes held in the India Office Records (British Library), the National Archives of India, and the National Archives of Bangladesh.
3. SUBORDINATE LEGISLATION: Formal "subordinate legislation" in the modern sense (statutory rules, statutory orders) did not exist as a category in the pre-1858 period. Executive instructions took the form of Board of Revenue circulars, Governor-General's orders, administrative instructions, and standing orders. These were not systematically published in any gazette until much later.
4. BANGLADESH APPLICABILITY: The territory of present-day Bangladesh formed part of the Bengal Presidency (specifically the "Lower Provinces" or "Bengal Division"). After 1947, East Pakistan (later Bangladesh) inherited applicable pre-independence legislation. The Bangladesh Laws (Revision and Declaration) Act, 1973 formally declared which laws remained in force.
5. CURRENCY OF STATUS: The "status" indicated for each regulation reflects the best available information as of the date of compilation. Some regulations listed as "in force" may have been effectively superseded even if not formally repealed.

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